Global Trends (GlTr-1012)

Chapter-One

Understanding International Relations

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What is IR?

- It is a broad-range of interactions between people, groups, firms, associations, parties, nations or states or between these and (non) governmental international organizations that exist in different parts of the world.
- It is both a field of study (emerged in 1919) and practice/condition
- As a condition, it is the diplomatic-strategic relation of states; the cross-border transaction of all kinds – economic, social and political; the facts of international life; the actual conduct of relations among nations through diplomacy based on foreign policy
- As a discipline, it is the study of all relations – political, academic, economic, social; concerned with what states do on the world stage and how their action affect other states

Key points

- Participation in IR is inescapable
- Every people, nation or state is a minority in a world that is anarchic-an absence of a common sovereign
- There are legal, political and social differences between domestic and international politics.
- Distinction between domestic and international real but declining
- Philosophical debates about the fundamental nature of IR: Hobbes vs. Locke, Realist vs. Idealist
- The arena of IR is continually expanding- in terms of subject matter, number of states and actors

Evolution of International Relations

- It is associated with the rise of the sovereign state in medieval Europe.
- The political system of medieval Europe was thus a curious combination of the local and the universal. -local (feudalism)and universal (Roman Catholic Church and Holly Roman Empire)
- From the 14th century onward, the state emerged as a political entity between these two levels.
- Reformation and the rise of Protestantism
- The Thirty Years‘ War, 1618–1648,
- The Treaty of Westphalia, 1648- introduce inter-state relations, sovereignty, dispatching of Ambassadors (diplomatic engagements)
- Industrial revolutions,
- Colonization, decolonization, European statehood,


DENMARK
BALTIC SEA
NORTH SEA
PRUSSIA
Hamburg
Bremen
Oldenburg
Stettin
BRANDENBURG
Berlin
Vistula
ENGLAND
London
Rhine
Ems
Elbe
POLAND
NETHERLANDS
HOLY ROMAN EMPIRE
Aachen
Marburg
Dresden
Oder
SILESIA
Frankfurt
Prague
Paris
LORRAINE
Nürnberg
BOHEMIA
Regensburg
Seine
Strassburg
Stuttgart
BAVARIA
Danube
Loire
Vienna
Munich
FRANCHE-COMTÉ
Innsbruck
AUSTRIA
FRANCE
SWISS CONFEDERATION
SAVOY
Milan
REPUBLIC OF VENICE
Po
Venice
Parma
Garonne
Rhône
OTTOMAN EMPIRE
Florence
PAPAL STATES
Ebro
ADRIATIC SEA
Corsica
Rome
NAPLES
SPAIN
Naples
Balearic Islands
Sardinia
TYRRHENIAN SEA
MEDITERRANEAN SEA
Sicily
HOLY ROMAN EMPIRE
Area in the 16th century
0 100 200 mi
0 150 300 km
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THIRTY YEARS' WAR
CHANGE OF TERRITORY AT WESTPHALIA, 1648
Imperial/Catholic victory
Imperial/Catholic defeat
Gustavus's campaign 1631–32
Boundary of the Holy Roman Empire in 1648
To Sweden
To Brandenburg
To Transylvania
To Saxony
To France
To United Provinces
To Bavaria
To Poland
SWEDEN
Courland
Baltic Sea
DENMARK
Schleswig
Holstein
Wolgast, 1629
Eastern Pomerania
Prussia
Danzig
Western Pomerania
Mecklenburg
Bremen-Verden
Elbe
Wittstock, 1636
Brandenburg
Hönigfelde, 1629
Neman
Vistula
North Sea
ENGLAND
UNITED PROVINCES
Lutter, 1626
Magdeburg
Halberstadt
Warsaw
Wesel
The Downs, 1639
Stadtlohn, 1623
Cleves
Westphalia
Dessau Bridge, 1626
Breitenfeld, 1631 & 1642
POLAND
Spanish Netherlands
Mark
Cologne
Lützen, 1632
Lusatia
Fleurus, 1622
Ducal Saxony
Electoral Saxony
Silesia
English Channel
Berg
Cologne
Lens, 1648
Jülich
Höchst, 1622
White Mountain, 1620
Oder
Rocroi, 1643
Luxembourg
Mainz
Prague
Kraków
Mergentheim, 1645
Principality of Zweibrücken
Lower Palatinate
Upper Palatinate
Bohemia
Jankov, 1645
Paris
Metz
Záblati, 1619
Moravia
Verdun
Wimpfen, 1622
Wiesloch, 1622
Upper Austria
Toul
Allerheim, 1645
Peuerbach, 1626
Lower Austria
Vienna
FRANCE
Nördlingen, 1634
Rain, 1632
Bavaria
Zusmarshausen, 1648
Vöcklabruck, 1626
Seine
Freiburg, 1644
Tuttlingen, 1643
Loire
Rhine
Alsace
Rheinfelden, 1638
Pest
Buda
Franche-Comté
Salzburg
Styria
Transylvania
SWISS CONFEDERATION
Tyrol
Carinthia
Drava
Danube
Geneva
Hungary
REPUBLIC OF VENICE
Carniola
0 25 75 125 mi
0 100 200 km
SAVOY
MILAN
Rhône
Adriatic Sea
Sava
OTTOMAN EMPIRE
Po
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Actors in IR

- Entities that have a role and capacity to make difference in IR
- They are individual/group who pursue certain goal through cooperation/conflict at the international stage
- Traditionally, state was the central actor. However, the international context is changed and multiple actors are involved in IR in contemporary era
- State became not the sole actor but act as the primary actor
- Two groups of Actors;
  - State Actors: the primary actor, 195 states in the world, similarities and differences
  - Non-State Actors
    - International governmental organizations Eg: UN, AU, EU, IGAD
    - International non-governmental organizations: E.g: Red Cross, Amnesty International, MSF,
    - Multinational corporations Eg: Coca Cola, Toyota
    - Groups
    - Individuals

Level of Analysis in IR

Frame of reference

- **The individual level**

It focuses on the behaviors, motivations, beliefs and orientation of the individual in affecting a particular international phenomenon. And also implications of human nature.

Eg. Hitler and WWII, Ethio-Eritrean rapprochement and Abiy, Germany Migration policy and Merkel, Ukraine-Russian War and Putin,

- **The group level**

It break the analysis down into certain kinds of groups, how they relate to the state level and where they position themselves with respect to the global issues.

Eg. the global financial crisis as the “misrule of experts”, the role of lobbyist group, voters, political parties

❖ **The state level**

Its focus remains on the state as the dominant unit of analysis-"state-centrism" of the discipline.

It focuses on state's actions and decisions, how they interact with each other to deal with the crisis, the kinds of states, their geographical position, their historical ties and experiences, their economic standing, their foreign policy.

❖ **The system level**

It conceive the global system as the structure or context within which states cooperate, compete and confront each other over issues of national interest.

The focus includes the distribution of power amongst states; the global economic, political and security structure. Eg. Anarchic nature of the international system and how it affects state behavior in IS

The Structure of International System

The distribution of capabilities/political power in the IS.

Three main types of systems:

- Uni-polar system-there is one state with the greatest political, economic, cultural and military power and hence the ability to totally control other states.
- Bipolar system-two super-powers and vulnerable for zero-sum game politics, Cold War
- Multipolar system-equally powerful states competing for power WWI

Theories of International Relations

Three categories-traditional theories, middle-ground theories and critical theories.

Idealism/Liberalism

- It is referred to as 'utopian' theory
- Its origin goes back to 18thc philosophers-Immanuel Kant who assumes that "states that shared liberal values should have no reason for going to war against one another."-democratic peace theory

Basic Assumption

- Human beings as innately good
- There is a greater potential for cooperation among states
- The permanent cessation of war is an attainable goal- Wilson's 14 points and League of Nations
- It advocates democratic governance and institutionalized law-governed relations of cooperation between states
- The prospects for the elimination of war lay with a preference for democracy over aristocracy, free trade over autarky, and collective security over the balance of power system'
- International law offers a mechanism by which cooperation among states is made possible- a key source of order in IS

Realism

- It emerged in the late 1930s and early 1940s in response to “wishful thinking” assumption of idealism/liberalism
- Difference b/n fact and value, what is and what ought to be
- It’s origin traced back to the works of Thucydides, Machiavelli, and Hobbes (State of nature-war of all against all-social contract-government).
- E.H. Carr‘s “Twenty Years‘ Crisis” (1939) and Hans Morgenthau’s “Politics among Nations”(1948) forms the foundation of realist theory of IR.

Basic Assumption

- They have pessimist view of human nature-human beings are not inherently good rather selfish
- International system is anarchic-devoid of all-encompassing authority
- International politics is a struggle for power‘, and conflict is the continual feature of international relations
- The state as the primary unit of analysis, and their interactions is governed by the relentless pursuit of power
- Values are context bound, that morality is determined by interest, and that the conditions of the present are determined by historical processes.
- International law is non-binding and ultimately ineffectual in the regulation of relations between states..

What are the differences between idealism/liberalism and realist theory of IR?

- Human nature
- International system
- International organizations
- State behavior in the international order
- Actors

Marxism

- It is originated from the writings of Karl Marx and F. Lenin
- It is based on the theory of class contradiction
- Criticized capitalism which created two sharp and polarized economic classes, i.e. the proletariat and bourgeoisie

Main Points

- It focuses on the inequalities that exist within the international system, inequalities of wealth between the rich 'North' or the First World' and the poor 'South' or the Third World'.
- And also dependency and exploitation created by the international division of labor which relegated the vast majority of the global population to the extremes of poverty
- Most states were not free, instead they were subjugated by the political, ideological and social consequences of economic forces- Imperialism
- The capitalist structure produced unequal exchange, center–periphery class relations in the international system
- Major writers in this perspective emerged from Latin America, Africa and the Middle East, primary among which were Andre Gunter Frank and Samir Amin

Constructivism

- It is commonly viewed as a middle ground theories.
- It highlight the importance of values and shared interests between individuals who interact on the global stage.
- The prominent constructivist is Alexander Wendt- described the relationship between agents (individuals) and structures (such as the state).

Basic Assumptions

- Anarchy is “what states make of it”- those interacting on the world stage have accepted international anarchy as the defining principle, it has become part of our reality.
- Ideas, or ‘norms’ have power and can be emerged over time
- Different states can perceive anarchy differently and the qualities of anarchy can even change over time.
- The essence of international relations exists in the interactions between people.

Critical Theories

- They emerged in response to mainstream approaches in the field, mainly liberalism and realism.
- They oppose commonly held assumptions, identify positions that have typically been ignored or overlooked within IR.
- They also provide a voice to individuals who have frequently been marginalized, particularly women and those from the Global South.
- They focuses on emancipation and empowerment
- Some critical theories include post-colonialism, feminism

Thank You!!!